Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be" ESTABLISHED 1888

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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: January 24, 2025

From: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

Re: Volunteer Appreciation Historical Data

BACKGROUND/OVERVIEW

The Township historically held a Volunteer Appreciation Dinner which included a sit down catered dinner, alcohol and recognition gifts.

Year	Cost	Event
2001	$2,730.35	Dinner
2002	$3,349.12	Dinner
2003	$2,317.55	Dinner
2004	$2,503.84	Dinner
2005	$2,617.73	Dinner
2006 Election Year	$2,715.92	Dinner
2007	$ 765.00	Luncheon – possibly staff only
2008	$ 61.25	Luncheon – possibly staff only
2009	$2,781.40	Dinner – last year for alcohol provision
2010 Election Year		
2011		
2012		
2013	$2,376.64	Gifts and dinner
2014 Election Year		
2015		
2016		
2017	$1,987.46	Dinner
2018 Election Year		
2019		
2020		
2021		
2022 Election Year	$2,109.28	*COVID – Gifts were delivered to doorstep of volunteers
2023		
2024		

In response to challenging financial and public liability issues, the appreciation event was moved to once every Council term. It is recommended to host the event in the year prior to a municipal election to eliminate any concerns of perception of campaigning during the event.

Removing alcohol from the event saved money, liability and preparation for the event. Spending municipal funds on alcohol is increasingly inappropriate use of public money and should be avoided in future events.

In 2022, gift bags were prepared using locally sourced items from small businesses located in the Township and surrounding areas. These bags were delivered to the volunteers by members of Council, maintaining social distancing protocols.

Previous gifts purchased for the event include flower arrangements, Township of Nipissing mugs, Nipissing Township Museum merchandise including candy bags and clothing/hats.

RESULTS

2025 is the year prior to a municipal election and is the time frame to consider an appreciation event for volunteers.

The number of volunteers to be considered:

VOLUNTEER POSITION	NUMBER OF VOLUNTEERS
Fire Department	25 (previously we have included spouses/significant others in acknowledgment for support of Firefighters) 25 spouse/significant other
Committees – appointed by Council	19
Volunteers recommended by Council members for ongoing support of events	Approximately 10

Staff are also invited to the dinner to acknowledge their contribution to events and committees as well as operation of the Township.

Staff: 14
Council: 5

Total approximate attendance for event: 136
Recommended venue: Township of Nipissing Community Centre

RECOMMENDATIONS:

Staff recommends:

a) Appointing a member of Council to work with Staff in the planning of this event.
b) Selecting a date for the event.
c) Selecting the type of event to be held.
d) Providing a budget amount to include: meal, appreciation gift, entertainment (if having).

Respectfully,

Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator